

Shield Master Fund Complaints website

A standalone claims site operated by Banton Group. Not live. Prepared 29 September 2026.

What follows

- Page 2: the full page as it would appear on a desktop browser.
- Page 3: the same page on a mobile phone.

How the site is pitched

- A standalone Shield site, one of two campaign streams (the other is First Guardian). It is built for the Shield cohorts: Macquarie investors whose capital was repaid, Equity Trustees investors who have not been repaid, and MWL and InterPrac clients.
- It leads with the fact that AFCA is free and that investors can complain themselves, with links to AFCA and the ASIC-funded Take Your Super Back tool. That matches what ASIC and AFCA tell investors, and it is what separates us from claims agents.
- It then sets out the eight situations where our help is most likely to change the outcome, and the 1 July 2027 date that matters for CSLR.
- Fees: free assessment; no win, no fee; nothing upfront; a fixed fee of \$5,000 including GST, payable only from compensation received.
- It carries a scam warning, a factual list of the class actions already filed, and a short intake form that feeds Formstack and Actionstep.

Open before launch

- Form of the conditional costs agreement and costs disclosure.
- Domain name, hosting, privacy collection statement and terms of use.
- Compliance read of all copy against r 36 of the *Australian Solicitors' Conduct Rules 2015* and the Australian Consumer Law before any advertising runs.
- Facts on the "Where things stand" panel to be refreshed on launch day.

Shield Master Fund Complaints

Help with AFCA and CSLR claims, from Banton Group

[When we can help](#)

[How it works](#)

[Fees](#)

[Questions](#)

[Free assessment](#)

SHIELD MASTER FUND (KEYSTONE ASSET MANAGEMENT)

Lost superannuation in the Shield Master Fund?

Make sure your complaint to AFCA is complete, correct and made in time. We will assess your position free of charge, and act for you on a no win, no fee basis where our help will make a difference.

[Get a free assessment](#)

[Or complain yourself, for free](#)

✓ Free assessment ✓ Nothing to pay upfront ✓ No win, no fee

THE DATE THAT MATTERS

1 July 2027

If your adviser's business has collapsed, the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort can pay an AFCA award up to \$150,000. For investors whose capital Macquarie has repaid, the Scheme has said it will generally not cover the lost returns that remain on complaints made on or after 1 July 2027. For many Macquarie investors, lost returns are most of what is left.

Source: CSLR, Shield and First Guardian resources, 10 September 2026. The Government has also proposed limiting Scheme payments to actual losses for complaints made after 30 June 2027.

afca.org.au

takeyoursuperback.com

You can complain to AFCA yourself, and it is free

AFCA does not charge you, and you do not need a lawyer to use it. ASIC has funded a free online tool to help you prepare a complaint. If your situation is straightforward, we will tell you so and point you to these resources rather than act for you.

WHEN OUR HELP IS WORTH HAVING

Some complaints are not straightforward

These are the situations where a lawyer is most likely to change the outcome for Shield investors. If one of them applies to you, ask us for a free assessment.

01

Macquarie repaid your capital

You may still be owed the returns you would have earned in your old fund. AFCA has awarded these even after Macquarie's repayment.

02

You invested through Equity Trustees

Members of AMG Super and Super Simplifier have not been repaid. ASIC is suing the trustee, but that case will not be heard before 2027.

03

Your adviser was with MWL

MWL Financial Services is in liquidation. If AFCA decides in your favour, the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort can pay, up to \$150,000.

04

You were advised through InterPrac

AFCA has paused decisions on InterPrac complaints while InterPrac's court case against AFCA runs. We keep your complaint on track.

05

More than one adviser or platform

Every responsible firm needs to be identified and included in your complaint, or you may leave compensation behind.

06

You used an SMSF

Your fund is the complainant, and the cost of winding up the SMSF can form part of the claim.

07

Your loss is over \$150,000, or you lost insurance

The Scheme's cap is \$150,000, and life, TPD or trauma cover lost on the switch can be part of the claim. We look at what else can be recovered.

08

You are in a class action or offered a deed

We check how the Macquarie class action affects your complaint, and whether any deed or settlement asks you to give up other rights.

WHERE THINGS STAND

What has happened with Shield

FEBRUARY 2024

ASIC stops new investment

ASIC made interim stop orders halting new offers of Shield.

JUNE TO AUGUST 2024

Assets frozen, receivers appointed

The Federal Court froze Shield's assets and appointed receivers. Keystone has since gone into liquidation.

AUGUST 2025

ASIC sues Equity Trustees

ASIC is suing Equity Trustees over about \$160 million invested in Shield, seeking compensation for members.

SEPTEMBER 2025

Macquarie repays capital

Macquarie repaid about \$321 million invested in Shield by its members, less withdrawals.

JUNE 2026

ASIC sues Keystone's directors

ASIC alleges about \$305 million was moved to related entities without proper safeguards.

NOW

AFCA and the Scheme

AFCA is deciding complaints against most advisers, but InterPrac complaints are paused until at least February 2027, and the Scheme is waiting for funding.

Last updated 29 September 2026. Sources: ASIC, AFCA and CSLR publications and court records.

HOW IT WORKS

Five steps

1

Tell us about it

Complete the form and upload any statements, advice documents or letters you have.

2

Free assessment

We tell you whether you need us. If you do not, we say so and point you to free help.

3

We prepare your complaint

If we act, we identify every responsible firm and prepare and lodge your complaint with AFCA.

4

We deal with AFCA

We respond to the firms and to AFCA and check AFCA's loss calculation.

5

The Scheme, if needed

If your adviser cannot pay, we make your claim to the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort.

No win, no fee

Nothing to pay upfront.

Free initial assessment.

A **fixed fee of \$5,000, including GST**, agreed in writing before we start.

Payable **only from compensation** you receive. If you receive nothing, you pay nothing.

You have **five business days** to change your mind after signing.

ABOUT OUR FEES

What you are paying for

AFCA and the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort do not charge you. Our fee is for our work on your complaint, not for access to AFCA.

Where a complaint is complex, we will ask AFCA to order the financial firm to contribute to your legal costs. AFCA usually caps a contribution at \$5,000 and does not always make one. Any contribution reduces what you pay us.

We only take on a complaint where the likely compensation is well above our fee. Before you sign anything we will give you a written costs agreement and disclosure explaining the fee, when it is payable and your rights.

CLASS ACTIONS

Class actions already filed

Other law firms have started these class actions against Macquarie. We are not acting in them. If you are a group member, we will check how it affects your complaint. No class action has been filed for Equity Trustees members.

Proceeding	Court	Law firm	Who it covers
<i>Dessent v Macquarie Investment Management Ltd</i>	Supreme Court of Victoria, S ECI 2026 06235	Gordon Legal	Macquarie Superannuation Plan members who invested in Shield between 1 March 2022 and 5 June 2023
<i>Buttgieg v Macquarie Bank Limited</i>	Federal Court of Australia, QUD425/2026	AG Edwards	The applicant has applied to discontinue this proceeding

Current at 29 September 2026, from court records and the firms' published information.



Beware of recovery scams

ASIC has warned about people offering to recover lost superannuation in return for money paid in advance or a share of your compensation. We will never ask you for an upfront payment, a deposit, a bond or a "tax". Banton Group is a law practice regulated in New South Wales. If you are unsure whether a message is from us, call our office on (02) 8076 8090.

FREE ASSESSMENT

Tell us about your Shield investment

It takes about five minutes. We will review what you send and contact you within five business days. Sending us your details does not commit you to anything.

If you have already complained to AFCA, include your AFCA complaint number and we will review where it has got to.

First name	Last name
Email	Mobile
Platform or super fund	Adviser or licensee
Macquarie, Equity Trustees, SMSF, other	MWL, InterPrac, FSGA, UGC, other
Amount invested (approximate)	Has Macquarie repaid your capital?
\$	Select
Complained to AFCA already?	Invested through an SMSF?
Select	Yes / No
Anything else we should know	
Upload statements, statements of advice or letters (optional)	
☐ I agree to Banton Group contacting me about my investment and complaint.	
☐ I have read the Privacy Collection Statement.	
Send for free assessment	

QUESTIONS

Common questions

Do I need a lawyer to complain to AFCA?

No. AFCA is free and designed to be used without a lawyer. We act only where your circumstances make our involvement worthwhile, and we will tell you if they do not.

I invested through Equity Trustees and have not been repaid.

You can complain to AFCA about your adviser now. ASIC's case against Equity Trustees seeks compensation for members, but it will not be heard before 2027.

My adviser was with InterPrac. What now?

AFCA is still accepting and investigating InterPrac complaints, but will not make decisions until InterPrac's case against AFCA ends. Make your complaint now so it is in the queue.

Macquarie repaid my money. Do I still have a claim?

Possibly. AFCA has ordered advisers to pay the returns investors would have earned in their previous fund, after allowing for Macquarie's repayment. The 1 July 2027 date matters for these claims.

My adviser was with MWL. What happens?

MWL is in liquidation. If AFCA decides in your favour and MWL cannot pay, you can apply to the Compensation Scheme of Last Resort, which pays up to \$150,000 including interest.

How much will it cost me?

Nothing upfront, and nothing if your complaint does not succeed. If you receive compensation, our fixed fee is \$5,000 including GST, paid from that compensation. AFCA itself is free.

Banton Group

Level 12, 60 Martin Place
Sydney NSW 2000
(02) 8076 8090

Free help

Australian Financial Complaints Authority:
afca.org.au
Take Your Super Back: takeyoursuperback.com
Compensation Scheme of Last Resort:
cslr.org.au

This site

Privacy Collection Statement
Terms of use
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Last name

Email

Mobile

Platform or super fund

Macquarie, Equity Trustees, SMSF, other

Adviser or licensee

MWL, InterPrac, FSGA, UGC, other

Amount invested (approximate)

\$

Has Macquarie repaid your capital?

Select

Complained to AFCA already?

Select

Invested through an SMSF?

Yes / No

Anything else we should know

Upload statements, statements of advice or letters (optional)

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